



Anthropic's website design and visual architecture

A reverse-engineered playbook for recreating the warmth, editorial clarity, technical rigor, layout logic, interaction style, and graphic language in a new—but original—project.

Scope	Public Anthropic marketing, company, research, and newsroom pages; brand case-study evidence; reusable implementation guidance.
Snapshot	Observed and researched on 4 September 2026. The live website will continue to evolve.
Use	Product briefs, design tokens, Figma libraries, content guidelines, front-end architecture, illustration briefs, and QA.
Important	This is an independent analysis, not Anthropic's official brand manual. Do not reuse its logos, proprietary fonts, photography, or illustrations without permission.

How to read this document

The audit separates *what is publicly verifiable* from *what is a useful implementation approximation*. This matters because a website's rendered appearance can be studied, while its internal tokens, breakpoints, CMS schema, and private brand rules cannot be known with certainty from the outside.

Confidence label	Meaning
Verified	Stated by Anthropic, its commissioned design studio, or directly visible in current public content.
Observed	Repeated visual pattern inferred from public pages and imagery.
Recommended	A production-ready value or rule that recreates the character without claiming to be Anthropic's internal specification.

The one-sentence model

Treat the site as a calm editorial publication about consequential technology: **human warmth in the materials, mathematical discipline in the grid, and almost no decorative interface chrome.**

Contents

How to read this document	2
1 Executive design diagnosis	3
2 Brand theme and design principles	4
3 Language, voice, and content design	4
4 Color system	5
5 Typography	7
6 Layout, grid, spacing, and composition	8
7 Information architecture and page families	10
8 Component system	11
9 Graphics, illustration, photography, and data visualization	12
10 Responsive behavior	15
11 Interaction, accessibility, and trust	15
12 Front-end design architecture	16
13 Recreation blueprint	17
14 Compact specification sheet	18
15 Source notes and limitations	19

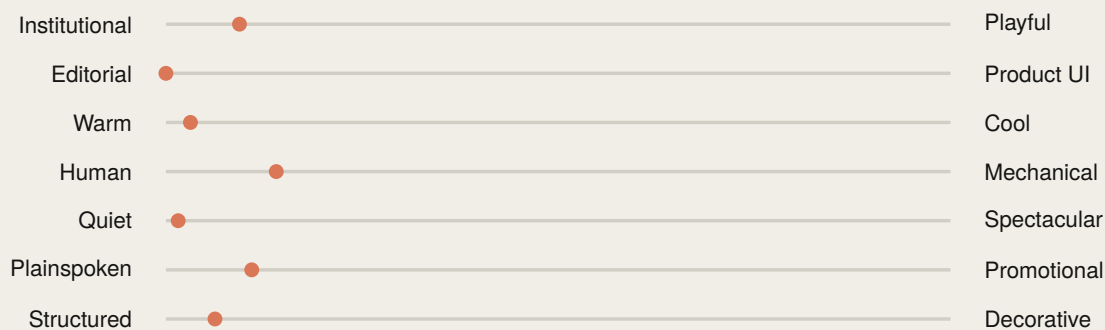
1 Executive design diagnosis

1.1 What makes the design recognizable

Anthropic avoids the category’s familiar visual shorthand: electric blues, glowing gradients, glass panels, starbursts, robot imagery, and dense product dashboards. Its public website instead combines five signals:

1. **Editorial authority.** Large, compact sans-serif headlines sit beside measured serif prose. Pages read like a thoughtful journal or policy institution rather than a conventional SaaS landing page.
2. **Warm materiality.** Parchment, oat, clay, charcoal, and faded neutral surfaces make digital content feel printed and human.
3. **Technical restraint.** Thin rules, grids, indexes, tables, direct labels, and diagram-like composition signal rigor without resorting to generic “futuristic” graphics.
4. **Human presence.** Hand-drawn figures, hands, faces, and candid workplace photography keep the subject of AI connected to people.
5. **Mission-led language.** Safety, reliability, evidence, impact, and long-term benefit are introduced before aggressive sales language.

1.2 Design polarity map



The system is not sterile minimalism. Its warmth and irregular illustration prevent that. Nor is it rustic or nostalgic: geometry, indexing, and terse navigation keep it contemporary.

1.3 The governing contrast

The brand repeatedly holds two apparent opposites together:

Human	serif reading text, candid photography, hand-drawn marks	Technical	geometric sans, diagrams, data, grids
Warm	ivory and clay surfaces, generous breathing room	Serious	near-black ink, sober claims, strong hierarchy
Simple	few component types and obvious interactions	Deep	long-form research, detailed policy, dense footers
Distinctive	unusual typography and illustration	Quiet	restrained motion, limited accents, low visual noise

2 Brand theme and design principles

The commissioned studio Geist describes the identity as human-centered and technically crafted, with a typographic logo, a warm color system, an illustration language, photography, and an extensive component system. It also describes the website and CMS as modular. Those statements align with the public pages: different content types share a small family of repeatable layouts rather than one-off art direction on every screen.

01. Substance before spectacle

Lead with a proposition, evidence, or mission. Visual effects support the idea; they do not substitute for it.

02. Humanize, do not anthropomorphize

Show people thinking, making, testing, and collaborating. Avoid robot faces, synthetic brains, or imagery that pretends the model is a person.

03. Make complexity navigable

Use labels, categories, dates, summaries, indexes, and clear progression. Complex subject matter is acceptable; confusing presentation is not.

04. Earn attention with contrast

Use a very large idea, a dark field, or one clay accent. Do not make every component compete.

05. Let type carry the identity

Typography is the primary graphic system. If a composition is weak without illustration, first repair the type hierarchy and spacing.

06. Build modularly

Create primitives that can compose research indexes, launches, policy pages, company storytelling, and editorial articles without losing consistency.

3 Language, voice, and content design

3.1 Voice attributes

The public language presents confidence without swagger. The strongest reusable voice model is:

Attribute	Do	Avoid
Intelligent	Use precise nouns and verbs; explain the mechanism; name the uncertainty.	Inflated abstractions, unexplained jargon, or trying to sound clever.
Warm	Speak about people and consequences; use natural contractions and active voice.	Corporate cheerfulness, forced humor, or emotional manipulation.
Unvarnished	State limitations, tradeoffs, safeguards, and what is still unknown.	“Revolutionary,” “magical,” “effortless,” or absolute guarantees.
Collaborative	Frame the technology as a tool that works with researchers, teams, and institutions.	Replacement narratives or language that erases human judgment.
Evidence-led	Pair claims with results, publications, system cards, dates, or methods.	Feature claims without proof or source context.
Long-term	Connect an announcement to broader benefit, risk, and institutional responsibility.	Urgency for its own sake, fear of missing out, or artificial scarcity.

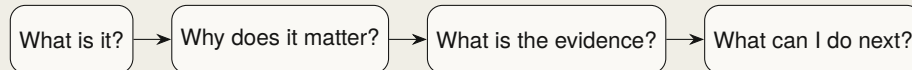
3.2 Sentence and headline architecture

- **Headline pattern:** declarative idea, normally in sentence case. Examples of the structure include “Making [systems] you can rely on” and “[Research and products] that put [principle] at the frontier.”
- **Deck pattern:** one or two calm sentences that explain why the page exists. Around 18–30 words is a useful landing-page target.

- **Section label:** short and literal—“Research,” “Our purpose,” “Publications,” “Latest releases.”
- **Card title:** describe the actual object or claim; do not use a teaser that withholds the subject.
- **Metadata:** category + date, or date + reading time. Metadata is compact, stable, and visibly secondary.
- **CTA:** usually two to four words: “Read more,” “Join us,” “See open roles,” “Try Claude.” The interface rarely needs theatrical copy.

3.3 Message order

The typical page answers questions in this sequence:



For high-stakes subjects, add “What are the limits or safeguards?” before the action. This order is one reason the site feels trustworthy: the CTA is not asked to carry the whole argument.

3.4 Reusable copy formula

Homepage hero formula

H1: [What we make or study] + [the human principle it serves].

Deck: [Scale of the change]. [Your role]. [Benefit and risk stated together].

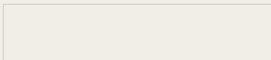
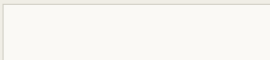
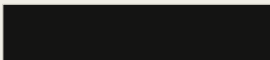
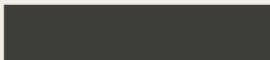
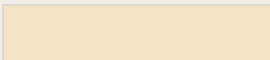
CTA: one primary route to learn or act; links inside the headline may also route to major domains.

	On-theme	Off-theme
Launch	“A more capable model for long-running research and coding work.”	“Meet the mind-blowing AI that changes everything.”
Safety	“We evaluate where safeguards fail and publish what we learn.”	“The safest AI, guaranteed.”
CTA	“Read the system card”	“Unlock the future now”
Error	“We could not load the publication list. Try again.”	“Oops! Something went wildly wrong.”

4 Color system

4.1 Palette character

The palette behaves like print materials rather than luminous screen color. The main neutral is not pure white, and the primary dark is not pure black. This tiny reduction in contrast temperature makes long pages feel calmer while retaining excellent luminance contrast.

			
Canvas #F0EEE6 page	Surface #FAF9F5 card	Ink #141413 text	Soft ink #3D3D3A secondary
			
Oat #E3DACC feature	Manilla #F5E3C7 feature	Clay #D97757 accent	Sage #B7C0AD support

			
Cloud #B0AEA5 inverse text	Cloud dark #87867F muted	Hairline #D1CFC5 border	Deep clay #A6482D accessible link

4.2 Token roles and usage

Token	Value	Use
canvas	#F0EEE6	Default page background; the visual equivalent of uncoated warm paper.
surface	#FAF9F5	Cards, article bodies, controls, and subtle separation from the canvas.
ink	#141413	Primary type, icons, strong outlines, and the inverted footer.
ink-soft	#3D3D3A	Supporting copy when a gentler hierarchy is useful.
text-muted	#5E5D59	Metadata and secondary details at accessible sizes.
hairline	#D1CFC5	Dividers, table rules, input borders, and card boundaries.
oat/manilla	as above	Alternating editorial fields, feature panels, and illustration backgrounds.
clay	#D97757	Sparse highlight, active marker, featured panel, or filled action. Use ink text on it.
clay-deep	#A6482D	Accessible small link text on the warm canvas; a practical darker adaptation.
inverse	#141413	Full-bleed footer or rare high-emphasis section, with Surface or Cloud text.

4.3 Recommended proportion

For a typical page, target roughly **70% warm canvas**, **20% light or oat surfaces**, **8% near-black type/fields**, and no more than **2% clay or other chromatic accent**. This is a compositional rule, not a literal pixel requirement. The accent is powerful because it is scarce.

4.4 Contrast audit

The following ratios are calculated from the working palette using the WCAG relative-luminance formula.

Pair	Ratio	Normal text	Guidance
Ink on Canvas	15.87:1	AAA	Default body and headline pairing.
Ink on Surface	17.50:1	AAA	Excellent for cards and inputs.
Soft ink on Canvas	9.38:1	AAA	Safe secondary copy.
Muted ink on Canvas	5.67:1	AA	Safe for normal metadata; do not make it tiny.
Cloud dark on Canvas	3.15:1	Fail	Decorative, disabled, or large text only.
Surface on Ink	17.50:1	AAA	Inverted headlines and primary footer copy.
Cloud on Ink	8.29:1	AAA	Footer navigation and secondary inverse copy.
Ink on Clay	5.90:1	AA	Correct filled-button pairing.
Deep clay on Canvas	5.04:1	AA	Practical accessible colored link.

Critical accessibility rule

Do not set white text on the mid-clay accent: it produces insufficient contrast for ordinary body text. Use Ink on Clay. Likewise, Cloud Dark is too faint for small text on Canvas. The authentic look comes from warm neutrals, not from making information hard to read.

5 Typography

5.1 Font provenance and present-day interpretation

Verified Geist's case study names **Styrene** by Commercial Type and **Tiempos** by Klim Type Foundry as the foundational typographic palette. Contemporary public references also describe brand-named Anthropic Sans, Serif, and Mono families. Because the live font files and licenses are not part of this audit, the safest conclusion is role-based: a characterful geometric grotesk carries display/interface text, while a literary serif carries reading text. A mono face supports technical metadata or code.

Role	Brand lineage	Recreation options
Display sans	Styrene / Anthropic Sans	License Styrene if authorized. Otherwise use Space Grotesk, Archivo, Sora, or a custom geometric sans; verify the personality rather than chasing identical metrics.
Reading serif	Tiempos / Anthropic Serif	License Tiempos if authorized. Alternatives: Source Serif 4, Newsreader, Charter, or Georgia. Favor sturdy small sizes and visible editorial character.
Technical mono	Anthropic Mono-like role	IBM Plex Mono, Source Code Pro, or ui-monospace. Use sparingly for code, model names, labels, and data.

5.2 Why the pairing works

The sans is compact, engineered, and self-aware; the serif is humane, reflective, and highly readable. Their contrast mirrors the brand's central idea: technical systems in service of human judgment. Setting everything in the sans would make the site feel like software marketing. Setting everything in the serif would weaken its computational precision.

5.3 Recommended responsive type scale

Style	Desktop	Mobile	Line height	Use
Display XL	64–76 px	42–50 px	0.98–1.04	Campaign or launch hero; use rarely.
H1	54–64 px	38–46 px	1.00–1.07	Primary marketing proposition.
H2	36–44 px	30–36 px	1.05–1.14	Major editorial section.
H3	23–28 px	21–25 px	1.15–1.25	Card or subsection heading.
Lead serif	20–24 px	18–21 px	1.35–1.48	Hero deck, introduction, pull quote.
Body serif	17–20 px	17–18 px	1.48–1.62	Articles and explanatory content.
UI/body sans	15–17 px	15–17 px	1.35–1.5	Navigation, controls, compact descriptions.
Label	11–13 px	11–13 px	1.25–1.4	Category, date, eyebrow; modest positive tracking.
Mono data	12–14 px	12–14 px	1.4–1.55	Code, table data, identifiers.

5.4 Typesetting rules

- Use **sentence case**; reserve all caps for very short labels.
- Apply mildly negative tracking to large sans headlines (approximately -0.01 to -0.025 em), never to serif body copy.
- Keep headline measures compact: roughly 8–13 words per line or 16–24 characters on narrow hero columns.
- Keep reading measure around 58–72 characters. Long research copy may reach 75, but not the full content grid.
- Prefer regular and medium weights. Heavy bold is a display tool, not a blanket emphasis style.

- Use underlining deliberately for important inline navigation; do not rely on color alone.
- Use true curly apostrophes and typographic quotation marks in editorial text; use lining numerals for tables and metadata.

Listing 1: Role-based web-font setup

```
:root {
  --font-display: "Styrene A", "Space Grotesk", Arial, sans-serif;
  --font-reading: "Tiempos Text", "Source Serif 4", Georgia, serif;
  --font-mono: "IBM Plex Mono", ui-monospace, monospace;
}

h1, h2, h3, nav, button, .label { font-family: var(--font-display); }
.lead, article p, blockquote { font-family: var(--font-reading); }
code, .data { font-family: var(--font-mono); }

h1 {
  font-size: clamp(2.625rem, 5vw, 4rem);
  line-height: 1.02;
  letter-spacing: -0.018em;
}
article p { max-width: 68ch; font-size: 1.125rem; line-height: 1.58; }
```

6 Layout, grid, spacing, and composition

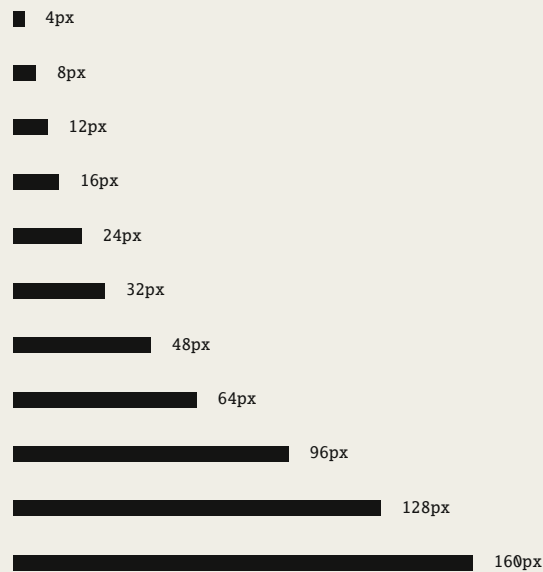
6.1 The core grid

The visual architecture alternates between broad editorial statements and highly ordered content lists. A practical reconstruction uses a centered 12-column grid with a maximum width around 1280 px, generous gutters, and a separate narrow reading column.

Variable	Recommended	Behavior
Outer max width	1240–1320 px	Holds navigation, heroes, grids, and footer columns.
Article width	680–760 px	Long-form reading body; figures may break wider.
Desktop columns	12	Major hero split commonly behaves like 7/5 or 8/4.
Tablet columns	8	Preserve asymmetry where useful, then stack.
Mobile columns	4	Single-column content with occasional two-up metadata.
Desktop gutter	24–32 px	Large enough to read as intentional negative space.
Page margin	24–32 px mobile; 48–80 px desktop	Fluid until the max width is reached.
Section rhythm	96–160 px desktop; 64–96 px mobile	Large pauses between ideas; tighter spacing inside components.
Card radius	16–24 px	Softens the system without making it bubbly.
Rule weight	1 px	Structural, low contrast, and used more often than shadows.

6.2 Spacing scale

Use a 4 px base with a deliberately sparse set of semantic steps:



The signature is not merely “lots of whitespace.” It is **unequal rhythm**: very large separation between narrative sections, moderate separation between related cards, and tight internal relationships between label, title, summary, and metadata.

6.3 Homepage wireframe



6.4 Composition rules

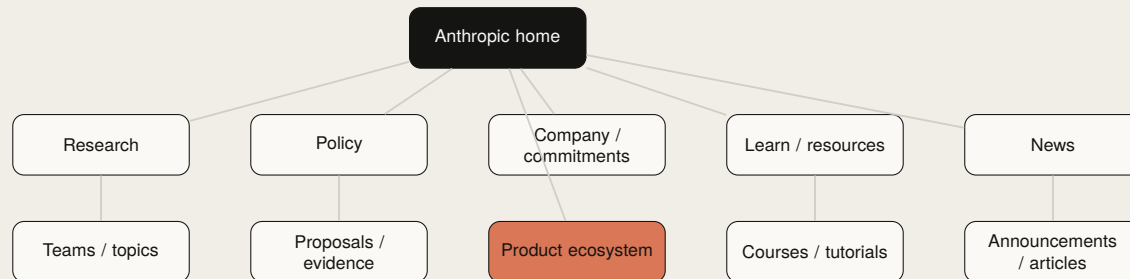
1. Start a section with a strong horizontal or column alignment. Let deliberate asymmetry occur *inside* that order.
2. Pair a large idea with a small explanation rather than two equally loud columns.
3. Avoid stacking many boxed panels. Lists separated by rules often feel more editorial and more authentic than card grids.
4. Let full-bleed dark or chromatic panels appear as punctuation, not the default container.
5. Use blank space to reveal hierarchy, not to hide a lack of content.

- On mobile, preserve the reading order: headline, deck, action, media, metadata. Do not preserve desktop asymmetry at the expense of logic.

7 Information architecture and page families

7.1 Top-level model

The current public architecture separates the company/research institution from product destinations while retaining a direct product CTA. The footer is far denser than the header, functioning as a complete directory.



7.2 Page templates

Template	Opening	Core modules
Homepage	Split editorial proposition + mission deck	Featured release, latest releases grid, mission statement, curated foundational links, directory footer.
Company	Declarative H1 + short identity statement + CTA	Purpose statement, capability/value columns, people photography, numbered values, governance, careers CTA.
Research index	Simple title + explanatory deck + topic links	Team summaries, featured publications, searchable date/category/title table, featured media, team CTA.
Newsroom	Literal title + press contacts/assets	Large featured media/story, selected headlines, searchable chronological index, media assets.
Article / research post	Category/date + strong headline + deck	Hero media; reading column; figures; notes; related content; share links.
Policy landing	Thesis about institutional problem	Featured proposals, evidence cards, chronological or thematic resources.
Campaign / launch	Oversized premise + distinctive hero graphic	Performance evidence, use cases, safeguards, quotes, technical details, CTA.

7.3 CMS content model

To reproduce the modularity, store content as structured fields instead of one giant rich-text blob.

Listing 2: Illustrative content schema

```

Entry
  id, slug, locale, status
  type: research | news | policy | company | product
  title, deck, eyebrow, category
  publishDate, updatedAt, readingTime
  authors[], researchTeam[], topics[]
  hero: {kind, asset, alt, focalPoint, backgroundToken}
  blocks[]: prose | figure | quote | metric | cards | table | code | callout
  
```

```

primaryAction, secondaryActions[]
relatedEntries[]
seo: {title, description, socialImage}

Navigation
compactHeaderItems[]
productAction
megaFooterGroups[]

```

The date/category/title list should be generated from entry metadata. This keeps indexes consistent and allows the same item to appear in a featured grid, a search result, and a related-content module without duplicated copy.

8 Component system

8.1 Header and navigation

- Keep the header visually light: wordmark at left, five or fewer institutional destinations, and one product action at right.
- Default height: 64–80 px desktop, 56–64 px mobile.
- Use the display sans around 14–16 px; no icon is required for every link.
- The primary action may be a simple outlined/filled compact control, but the wordmark and H1 should remain more prominent.
- Sticky behavior is optional. If sticky, use an opaque Canvas field and a hairline rather than heavy blur and shadow.
- On mobile, the expanded menu can become a full-height warm sheet with large text links and a visible close button.

8.2 Links and buttons

Type	Construction	Use
Inline link	Ink text, persistent 1 px underline, 2–4 px offset	Editorial navigation and links embedded in statements.
Text CTA	Sans medium + arrow or underline	Cards and section endings; often preferable to a button.
Primary action	Clay fill + Ink text; 44 px minimum height; 8–12 px or pill radius	The single decisive action on a page or campaign.
Secondary action	Transparent/Surface + Ink 1 px outline	Alternative route when needed.
Icon action	44 by 44 px target, simple line icon, accessible name	Menu, share, carousel, or media control only.

Hover states should be specific but quiet: underline thickens or shifts, arrow translates 2–4 px, surface warms slightly, or border darkens. Never communicate state using motion alone.

8.3 Editorial cards

There are three useful card families:

1. **Media card:** image or illustration on top; label, title, summary, and metadata below. Use for news and campaigns.
2. **Text card:** warm field, small label, 22–28 px title, serif summary, bottom-aligned action. Use for releases or topic gateways.
3. **Index row:** date/category/title arranged in columns with a hairline. Use when volume is high. This avoids turning a publication archive into an endless wall of tiles.



8.4 Search, filters, and content tables

Research and news archives benefit from controls that resemble editorial tools rather than an app dashboard:

- Full-width or wide search input with a literal label and visible keyboard focus.
- Topic/category filters as text, checkboxes, or restrained chips.
- Desktop header columns for Date, Category, and Title; on mobile, title first and metadata grouped below.
- Entire row may be clickable, but retain a semantic link on the title.
- Use pagination or an explicit “See more” action. Infinite scroll is poor for citation, orientation, and returning to a result.

8.5 Footer

The dark, full-width directory footer is a structural counterweight to the airy page. It can contain many links because contrast, grouping, and repeated small labels organize the density.

- 4–6 columns on wide screens; 2 columns on tablet; accordion or stacked groups on mobile.
- Surface/white for group headings and Cloud for ordinary links.
- 12–14 px sans, 8–12 px vertical link gaps, and generous top/bottom padding (72–112 px).
- Separate products, models, solutions, platform, resources, company, help/security, and legal. Do not mirror this density in the header.

9 Graphics, illustration, photography, and data visualization

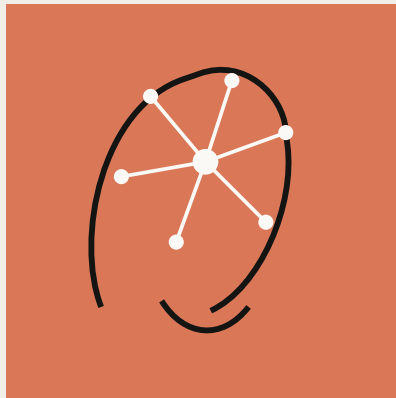
9.1 The graphic grammar

The foundational illustration language described and shown by Geist combines human subjects with technical overlays. Typical assets use a small set of ingredients:

- loose black contour drawings of hands, heads, gestures, or objects;
- clean white or pale geometric systems—nodes, rays, paths, circles, grids, puzzle pieces, or diagrammatic marks;
- one flat warm background such as clay, tan, oat, gray, or cream;
- visibly imperfect line rhythm, with no attempt at photorealism;
- a single centered metaphor that can be understood at thumbnail size;
- generous negative space and no decorative texture unless it supports the concept.

The result is a productive tension: the black drawing says “human,” the precise overlay says “system,” and their interaction says “technology aligned with people.”

9.2 Graphic construction anatomy



1. Human contour

Use one expressive, imperfect black line drawing. Keep anatomy legible but simplified.

2. Technical overlay

Add one precise white system: graph, ray field, grid, target, path, or measurement.

3. Flat material field

Use one warm, desaturated background. The concept, not rendering complexity, supplies interest.

9.3 Metaphor library

Build an original library from concept pairs rather than copying existing illustrations.

Idea	Human layer	System layer
Collaboration	several hands or shared object	converging paths, common target, interlocking modules
Interpretability	face/profile, eye, opened object	graph nodes, traced paths, layers, highlighted circuit
Safety	hand holding or shielding	boundary, guardrail, concentric zones, checkpoint
Learning	hand writing, reading figure	branching map, constellation, indexed steps
Steerability	hand on a tool or wheel	vector field, directional arrows, controlled trajectory
Evaluation	eye, measuring gesture	scale, axes, checklist, comparison grid
Long-term impact	walking figure, seed, horizon	timeline, expanding rings, mapped milestones
Institutions	group of people, building fragment	network, linked nodes, balanced framework

9.4 A repeatable illustration workflow

Vector-first production method

1. Write the editorial idea in one sentence. Underline the human noun and the technical noun.
2. Sketch 12 thumbnail metaphors in black only. Select the one that reads at 80 px.
3. Draw the human layer with a pressure-sensitive brush. Limit stroke widths to roughly two levels and retain small imperfections.
4. Rebuild the technical layer as exact vectors with consistent nodes, angles, and spacing.
5. Choose one background token and one overlay color. Avoid additional colors until a clear information need exists.
6. Test on 1:1 card, 16:9 hero, and narrow mobile crop. Define a safe focal area in the CMS.
7. Export SVG for flat artwork; provide optimized PNG/WebP fallbacks when filters, grain, or raster drawing is involved.
8. Add alt text that communicates the editorial meaning, not every decorative line.

9.5 Using generative image tools without losing the system

Generative output is most useful for ideation or the hand-drawn base layer; the geometric overlay, color, crop, and line consistency should be art-directed and rebuilt deliberately.

Reusable image brief

Create an original editorial illustration about *[concept]*. Show one simplified human gesture or object in loose, bold black contour line. Overlay one precise white geometric system representing *[technical mechanism]*. Use a flat muted *[clay/oat/manilla/sage]* background, generous negative space, no gradients, no 3D rendering, no robot imagery, no text, and no copied brand symbols. The image must remain legible as a small article thumbnail.

Post-processing checklist:

- redraw hands/faces that contain anatomical artifacts;
- remove pseudo-text and accidental icons;
- normalize black stroke weight across the asset family;
- rebuild nodes and lines on a vector grid;
- remap colors to the project tokens;
- compare silhouette, crop, and concept against existing library assets to avoid repetition;
- record provenance, prompt, model, edits, license, and approval status.

9.6 Photography direction

The company pages use people-at-work photography to establish credibility and culture. A compatible original art direction is:

- candid collaboration, research, discussion, and concentration rather than staged portraits pointing at screens;
- natural daylight, warm white balance, restrained saturation, and believable skin tones;
- environmental context—whiteboards, plants, tools, notebooks, meeting rooms—without turning the office into a prop;
- mixed wide scenes, medium interactions, and tactile details;
- eye-level viewpoints and quiet framing; avoid extreme wide-angle tech imagery, cyan light, or fake holograms;
- room for responsive cropping and adjacent text; store focal points and subject-safe zones.

9.7 Charts and technical figures

Data visualization should borrow the same editorial discipline:

- Canvas or Surface background; Ink axes and labels; Hairline grid.
- One Clay series for the focal result, Soft Ink for the comparator, and muted neutrals for context.
- Directly label series where possible; legends should not force visual ping-pong.
- Keep axis titles literal, units visible, baselines honest, and notes close to the figure.
- Avoid 3D charts, rainbow palettes, glowing lines, and decorative data particles.
- Every figure needs a plain-language takeaway and accessible data table when the values matter.

9.8 Motion language

Motion should feel explanatory, not ambient. Recommended patterns are 150–250 ms interface transitions, 400–700 ms editorial reveals, simple opacity/translation, line drawing for diagrams, and count/trace animation for data. Use one easing family such as `cubic-bezier(.2, .7, .2, 1)`. Respect `prefers-reduced-motion`; never autoplay sound; and do not animate every card on scroll.

10 Responsive behavior

Range	Grid	Adaptation
1280 px+	12 columns	Max-width container; 7/5 heroes; 3–4 cards; multi-column footer.
1024–1279 px	12 or 8 columns	Reduce outer margin and headline size; maintain split heroes where copy remains readable.
768–1023 px	8 columns	Stack complex hero media; use 2-card grids; simplify footer; collapse secondary nav.
480–767 px	4 columns	Single-column narrative; 24 px margins; cards stack; archive rows become title + metadata blocks.
Below 480 px	4 fluid columns	16–20 px margins; clamp display type; avoid fixed-height media; make controls full-width when useful.

10.1 Mobile is not a compressed desktop

Preserve the brand by retaining generous vertical pauses, readable serif prose, the warm canvas, and strong headline scale. Remove complexity through sequencing, not through miniaturization. Any decorative graphic may crop, but the conceptual subject and primary technical overlay must remain visible.

11 Interaction, accessibility, and trust

11.1 Interaction states

Every interactive component needs default, hover, active, focus-visible, disabled, loading, success, and error behavior. The visual system can remain quiet while making those states explicit:

- **Focus:** 2 px Ink outline plus 2–3 px Canvas/Surface offset, or an accessible Deep Clay ring.
- **Hover:** border darkening, underline change, or tiny arrow translation; no layout shift.
- **Loading:** use a textual status and restrained skeleton; avoid indefinite ornamental animation.
- **Error:** explain the problem, preserve entered data, and offer the next action. Color is supplementary.
- **Disabled:** if an action cannot be used, explain why nearby; low contrast alone is not an explanation.

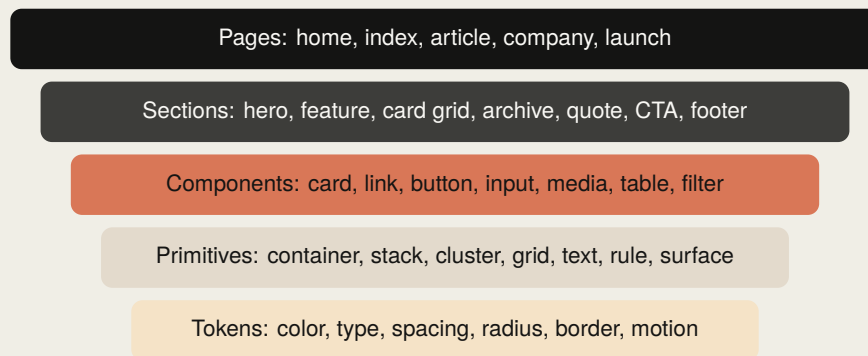
11.2 Accessibility baseline

1. Meet WCAG 2.2 AA at minimum; target AAA for core reading text.
2. Use semantic landmarks, a skip link, logical heading order, and a visible current-page state.
3. Minimum pointer target: 44 by 44 CSS px. Maintain 8 px separation between adjacent compact targets.

4. Do not use serif/sans difference, color, or animation as the sole carrier of meaning.
5. Allow 200% text zoom and 400% browser zoom without clipped controls or two-dimensional body scrolling.
6. Provide useful alt text, captions for video, transcripts for audio, and descriptions/tables for meaningful charts.
7. Honor reduced motion, increased contrast, forced colors, and user font preferences where practical.
8. Keep consent, safety, privacy, and system-limit language near the relevant action rather than buried in the footer.

12 Front-end design architecture

12.1 Layer model



Keep brand decisions in tokens and primitives. A research page and a launch page should not each invent their own almost-identical gray, headline, gutter, or card radius.

12.2 Starter CSS tokens

Listing 3: Production-oriented working tokens

```
:root {
  --color-canvas: #f0eee6;
  --color-surface: #faf9f5;
  --color-ink: #141413;
  --color-ink-soft: #3d3d3a;
  --color-text-muted: #5e5d59;
  --color-cloud: #b0aea5;
  --color-hairline: #d1cfc5;
  --color-oat: #e3dacc;
  --color-manilla: #f5e3c7;
  --color-clay: #d97757;
  --color-clay-deep: #a6482d;

  --space-1: .25rem; --space-2: .5rem; --space-3: .75rem;
  --space-4: 1rem; --space-6: 1.5rem; --space-8: 2rem;
  --space-12: 3rem; --space-16: 4rem; --space-24: 6rem;
  --space-32: 8rem; --space-40: 10rem;

  --radius-control: .625rem;
  --radius-card: 1.25rem;
  --border: 1px solid var(--color-hairline);
  --content-max: 80rem;
  --reading-max: 45rem;
  --ease-editorial: cubic-bezier(.2,.7,.2,1);
}

body { background: var(--color-canvas); color: var(--color-ink); }
```

```
.container { width: min(100% - 3rem, var(--content-max)); margin-inline: auto; }  
.section { padding-block: clamp(4rem, 9vw, 9rem); }  
.reading { width: min(100%, var(--reading-max)); }
```

12.3 Primitive APIs

Useful layout primitives reduce special-case CSS:

Listing 4: Illustrative component composition

```
<Page canvas="warm">  
  <Header compact productAction="Try product" />  
  <Main>  
    <EditorialHero split="7/5" titleAs="h1" />  
    <Feature tone="inverse" mediaPosition="right" />  
    <CardGrid columns={{ mobile: 1, tablet: 2, desktop: 3 }} />  
    <ArchiveIndex searchable fields=["date", "category", "title"] />  
  </Main>  
  <DirectoryFooter tone="inverse" />  
</Page>
```

12.4 Performance and asset rules

- Self-host only licensed font subsets; preload the critical display face carefully and use `font-display: swap` or an evaluated optional strategy.
- Prefer SVG for simple illustration and AVIF/WebP for photography. Provide explicit width/height or aspect ratio to prevent layout shift.
- Render article and index content server-side or statically. Search can progressively enhance the pre-rendered list.
- Keep initial JavaScript small. The design's power comes from HTML, CSS, typography, and content, not client-side spectacle.
- Set performance budgets: LCP under 2.5 s at the 75th percentile, CLS under 0.1, and INP under 200 ms as launch targets.

13 Recreation blueprint

13.1 Build sequence

1. **Define the project's own thesis.** Choose the human/technical tension that belongs to your organization. Do not begin with Anthropic's surface styling.
2. **Lock tokens and licenses.** Select original colors, licensed or open fonts, type scale, grid, spacing, and accessibility pairings.
3. **Prototype four primitives.** Container, Stack, Grid, and Text should reproduce the main page rhythm before cards are designed.
4. **Build the two extremes.** Create an airy editorial hero and a dense archive index. If both feel related, the system is robust.
5. **Create the content schema.** Add structured entries, media focal points, categories, dates, relationships, and blocks.
6. **Commission original graphics.** Use the grammar in Section 9, but choose metaphors, drawing character, and palette that are recognizably yours.
7. **Add states and responsive behavior.** Test keyboard, zoom, long titles, missing images, localization, slow networks, and reduced motion.
8. **Run a contrast and sameness audit.** Confirm accessibility and remove elements that too closely imitate identifiable proprietary assets.

13.2 Acceptance criteria

- ✓ One clear proposition above the fold.
- ✓ Serif and sans have distinct jobs.
- ✓ Warm neutral canvas, never arbitrary beige decoration.
- ✓ Headline and deck form an asymmetric but aligned pair.
- ✓ High-volume content uses an index, not only cards.
- ✓ Clay/accent use remains scarce.
- ✓ Dark footer organizes the complete ecosystem.
- ✓ Illustrations unite human contour and technical system.
- ✓ Copy names evidence, limits, and next steps.
- ✓ Mobile order remains semantically correct.
- ✓ All interactions work by keyboard.
- ✓ Normal text meets 4.5:1 contrast.

13.3 Common failure modes

Failure	Correction
“Beige SaaS” with generic Inter	Use a characterful display face, a true reading serif, stronger type scale, and editorial measures.
Every section is a rounded card	Return to open canvas, rules, lists, and typographic grouping. Cards are one tool.
Clay everywhere	Restrict it to one focal action or feature. Warm neutrals should dominate.
Random doodles	Tie each human drawing to a precise technical overlay and one editorial metaphor.
Marketing superlatives	Replace them with mechanism, evidence, limitation, and consequence.
Desktop design simply shrunk	Re-sequence content and preserve readable type/space on mobile.
Low-contrast authenticity	Use the accessible pairings in Section 4; warmth does not require faint text.
Literal copy of assets	Retain principles, then change typography, palette ratios, metaphors, icon shapes, and composition into an original identity.

14 Compact specification sheet

Design thesis	Warm editorial institution + precise technical system.
Canvas	Warm ivory #F0EEE6; light surface #FAF9F5.
Ink	Near-black #141413; avoid pure black as the default.
Accent	Muted clay #D97757, used sparingly with Ink text.
Typography	Characterful geometric display sans + literary reading serif + optional technical mono.
Grid	12 columns, 1240–1320 px max, 24–32 px gutters, 680–760 px article measure.
Rhythm	Tight inside content groups; 96–160 px between major desktop sections.
Shapes	Mostly open canvas and hairlines; 16–24 px card radius; almost no shadow.
Hero	Large sans thesis paired asymmetrically with short serif explanation.
Cards	Media card, warm text card, and compact archive row.
Graphics	Bold imperfect human contour + exact white technical overlay + flat warm field.
Photography	Candid, natural-light, contextual images of people doing real work.
Motion	Quiet, explanatory, short, and reduced-motion aware.
Voice	Intelligent, warm, unvarnished, collaborative, evidence-led.
Architecture	Tokens → primitives → components → sections → templates; structured CMS content.

15 Source notes and limitations

15.1 Primary public evidence

1. Anthropic homepage, accessed 4 September 2026:
<https://www.anthropic.com/>
2. Anthropic company page, including purpose, team imagery, values, and governance, accessed 4 September 2026:
<https://www.anthropic.com/company>
3. Anthropic research index, including team navigation, featured publications, and chronological table, accessed 4 September 2026:
<https://www.anthropic.com/research>
4. Anthropic newsroom, including press resources, featured stories, and chronological index, accessed 4 September 2026:
<https://www.anthropic.com/news>
5. Geist, “Anthropic,” describing its commissioned work on visual identity, typography, color, illustration, photography, component system, site architecture, and modular CMS:
<https://geist.co/work/anthropic>

15.2 Supporting references

1. Type.Today, “Styrene in use: ANTHROPIC,” documenting Styrene for headlines/subheads and Tiempos for body text:
<https://type.today/en/journal/anthropic>
2. Commercial Type, Styrene family description:
https://commercialtype.com/catalog/styrene/styrene_a
3. Refero Styles, third-party reverse-engineered color/type token study. Useful as corroboration, not an official source:
<https://styles.refero.design/style/d469cba4-c448-4a43-a033-883f8bfcdc42>

15.3 Limits of the audit

Exact production CSS, internal design tokens, proprietary font builds, analytics-driven breakpoints, unpublished brand rules, and CMS implementation were not available. Numerical layout and token values labeled as recommended are deliberately practical approximations. Before a production launch, inspect the current rendered implementation, validate font licensing, test color values in context, and conduct accessibility and legal review.

Final design lesson

The transferable value is not “cream background + clay button.” It is the architecture of the contrast: **warm materials make technical content approachable; rigorous typography and information design keep that warmth credible.** Preserve that relationship, then give the new project its own voice, symbols, and visual authorship.